

Practice Paper 1

Admiration and irony; memory and loneliness · Three hours · 100 marks

PAPER I · 40 MARKS

Answer **all** the questions in Section A. Select **either** I, II **or** III from Section B and answer all the questions given below it.

Paper I · Section A: Poetry, Prose and Drama 30 marks

Read the following extracts and answer all the questions given below them.

I POETRY

I (i) · PRACTICE QUESTION

"He clasps the crag with crooked hands;
Close to the sun in lonely lands,
Ring'd with the azure world, he stands."

(a) Name the poem from which these lines are taken. Name the poet.

1 mark

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(b) Who is referred to as 'he'?

1 mark

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(c) What are the 'crooked hands'?

1 mark

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(d) What impression of the eagle do these lines create? Refer to one poetic technique.

2 marks

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I (ii) · PRACTICE QUESTION

"So I have learned many things, son.
I have learned to wear many faces
like dresses – homeface,
officeface, streetface, hostface,"

(a) Name the poem from which these lines are taken. Name the poet.

1 mark

(b) Who is the speaker?

1 mark

(c) Name the poetic technique in 'like dresses'.

1 mark

(d) What does the speaker mean by 'wear many faces'? What is his attitude towards this?

2 marks

II PROSE

II (i) • PRACTICE QUESTION

"It was probably the first time for twenty years that anyone had smiled in that lumber-room."

(a) Name the text from which this line is taken. Name the author.

1 mark

(b) Who smiled in the lumber-room?

1 mark

(c) Why did he smile at this moment?

1 mark

(d) What does this sentence suggest about the lumber-room and about the aunt?

2 marks

II (ii) • PRACTICE QUESTION

"Not thirty seconds had passed when we heard what sounded like fire crackers going off. Suddenly a shout came from the front: 'Get down they are shooting at the bus.'"

(a) Name the text from which these lines are taken. Name the speaker/author. 1 mark

(b) Where were the speaker and his companions at this moment? 1 mark

(c) What did the 'fire crackers' turn out to be? 1 mark

(d) Comment on the effect of comparing the sound to 'fire crackers'. 2 marks

III DRAMA

III (i) • PRACTICE QUESTION

"I wished I might have lived with you forever, setting up our world in the middle of this field, playing with children and working on the farm."

(a) Name the play from which these lines are taken. Name the playwright. 1 mark

(b) Who speaks these words, and to whom? 1 mark

(c) At what point in the play are these words spoken? 1 mark

(d) What do these words reveal about the speaker? 2 marks

III (ii) • PRACTICE QUESTION

"That's real silly feminine logic. That's why I never did like, and don't like now, to have to talk to women. I'd rather sit on a barrel of gunpowder than talk to a woman."

(a) Name the play from which these lines are taken. Name the playwright.

1 mark

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(b) Who is the speaker?

1 mark

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(c) What has made the speaker so angry?

1 mark

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(d) Comment on the exaggeration in the last sentence. Why is it ironic later in the play?

2 marks

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Paper I • Section B: Novels 10 marks

Select **EITHER** I, II **OR** III and answer all the questions given below it.

I • THE PRINCE AND THE PAUPER

Read the following extract from *The Prince and the Pauper* by Mark Twain and answer all the questions given below it.

"The mock King's cheeks were flushed with excitement, his eyes were flashing, his senses swam in a delirium of pleasure. At this point, just as he was raising his hand to fling another rich largess, he caught sight of a pale, astounded face, which was strained forward out of the second rank of the crowd, its intense eyes riveted upon him. A sickening consternation struck through him; he recognised his mother! and up flew his hand, palm outward, before his eyes—that old involuntary gesture, born of a forgotten episode, and perpetuated by habit. In an instant more she had torn her way out of the press, and past the guards, and was at his side. She embraced his leg, she covered it with kisses, she cried, "O my child, my darling!" lifting toward him a face that was transfigured with joy and love. The same instant an officer of the King's Guard snatched her away with a curse, and sent her reeling back whence she came with a vigorous impulse from his strong arm. The words "I do not know you, woman!" were falling from Tom Canty's lips when this piteous thing occurred; but it smote him to the heart to see her treated so."

(i) When and where does this incident take place?

2 marks

(ii) Why did Tom say "I do not know you, woman!"?

2 marks

(iii) Explain the meaning of the following phrase as it occurs in the passage: (a) a sickening consternation

1 mark

(b) transfigured with joy and love

1 mark

(iv) How does this incident affect Tom? To what theme of the novel does it relate?

4 marks

II • BRINGING TONY HOME

As a boy, the narrator often wanders with his friends near the R.A.F. camp. One evening he watches a truck bring a white officer to his billet, and soon the notes of a piano come floating out. The narrator says:

"the music was vaguely familiar and the smell of roast beef was still in the air coming from Kitchen No.1 and I thought of the lonely nights I spent at 'Greenlands' in Havelock Town"

(i) When and where does this scene take place?

2 marks

(ii) Which two things bring back the narrator's memories of 'Greenlands'?

2 marks

(iii) Explain the meaning of the following phrase as it occurs in the passage: (a) vaguely familiar **1 mark**

(b) still in the air **1 mark**

(iv) What does this memory reveal about the narrator's feelings? To what theme of the novel does it relate? **4 marks**

III • THE VENDOR OF SWEETS

Mali has gone to America to learn to be a writer, and his letters begin to arrive in Malgudi. Narayan writes:

"Jagan stuffed his jibba pocket with the letters and pulled them out for choice reading of passages to all and sundry, mostly to his cousin, who, as ever, remained an uncomplaining listener. Gradually his reading of the Bhagavad Gita was replaced by the blue airmail letters."

(i) When does this take place, and to whom does Jagan read the letters most? **2 marks**

(ii) Why does Jagan carry the letters in his pocket? **2 marks**

(iii) Explain the meaning of the following phrase as it occurs in the passage: (a) all and sundry **1 mark**

(b) an uncomplaining listener **1 mark**

(iv) What is ironic about the last sentence? What does it reveal about Jagan?

4 marks

Paper II · Essays 60 marks

PAPER II · 60 MARKS

Answer **four** questions, selecting **one** each from the four sections: Poetry, Drama, Prose and Fiction.

HOW PAPER II ESSAYS ARE MARKED (15 MARKS EACH)

Content 7 · Organisation 4 · Language 4. Examiners reward relevant points from the text, apt quotations, a clear argument that answers the question, and your own sensible response. The points below are a guide, not a fixed list.

POETRY (Answer one question only)

1. In 'To the Nile', Keats moves from wonder at the river's legend to a more realistic view of it. Discuss with reference to the poem.

15 marks

2. "'War is Kind' uses bitter irony to attack those who glorify war." Examine how Stephen Crane achieves this.

15 marks

3. Okara's 'Once Upon a Time' contrasts the sincerity of the past with the falseness of the present. How does the poet present this contrast?

15 marks

4. "'Father and Son' presents two points of view, and the listener can understand both." Do you agree? Discuss with reference to the poem.

15 marks

5. How does Raymond Wilson create both suspense and humour in 'Two's Company'?

15 marks

DRAMA (Answer one question only)

6. "Tsu is destroyed not by her husband's cruelty but by the greed of others." Discuss with reference to 'Twilight of a Crane'.

15 marks

7. How does Chekhov use exaggeration and sudden changes of mood to entertain the audience in 'The Bear'?

15 marks

PROSE (Answer one question only)

8. "The extract from 'Wave' shows how quickly ordinary life can turn into tragedy." Discuss.

15 marks

9. Discuss how Saki uses humour and irony to criticise the aunt in 'The Lumber Room'.

15 marks

10. What qualities of a good leader does Kumar Sangakkara reveal in 'The Lahore Attack'?

15 marks

11. Contrast the Nightingale's idea of love with the Student's idea of love in 'The Nightingale and the Rose'.

15 marks

FICTION (Answer one question only)

12. "Tom Canty's experience as king shows that goodness matters more than noble birth." Discuss with reference to 'The Prince and the Pauper'.

15 marks

13. Discuss the role of memory in 'Bringing Tony Home'.

15 marks

14. "Jagan is a man of contradictions." Discuss with reference to 'The Vendor of Sweets'.

15 marks

These are original LitHelp practice questions written to the format of the G.C.E. (O/L) 2023(2024) and 2024(2025) papers and the Ministry of Education's 2025(2026) model papers. They are not official past-paper questions. For copyrighted set texts, only short lines are quoted and the situation is described in our own words.